

1. GDS weighs in on the NHS's decision to retreat from Open Source

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-17T15:59:41+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/17/gds-weighs-in/#atom-everything>

GDS weighs in on the NHS's decision to retreat from Open Source Terence Eden continues his coverage of the NHS' poorly considered decision to close down access to their open source repositories in response to vulnerabilities reported to them as part of Project Glasswing . Now the Government Digital Service have joined the conversation with AI, open code and vulnerability risk in the public sector , published May 14th. Their key recommendation: Keep open by default. Making everything private adds additional delivery and policy costs, and can reduce reuse and scrutiny. Openness should remain the default posture, with closure used sparingly and deliberately. While they don't mention the NHS by name, Terence speaks the language of the civil service and interprets this as a major escalation: Within the UK's Civil Service you occasionally hear the expression "being invited to a meeting without biscuits ". It implies a rather frosty discussion without any of the polite niceties of a normal meeting. In general though, even when people have severe disagreements, it is rare for tempers to fray. It is even rarer for those internal disagreements to spill over into public. Tags: open-source

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2. Llm 0.32a2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-12T17:45:07+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/12/llm/#atom-everything>

Release: Llm 0.32a2 A bunch of useful stuff in this LLM alpha, but the most important detail is this one: Most reasoning-capable OpenAI models now use the /v1/responses endpoint instead of /v1/chat/completions . This enables interleaved reasoning across tool calls for GPT-5 class models. #1435 This means you can now see the summarized reasoning tokens when you run prompts against an OpenAI model, displayed in a different color to standard error. Use the -R or --hide-reasoning flags if you don't want to see that. Tags: llm , projects , openai , generative-ai , annotated-release-notes , ai , llms

3. Using LLM in the shebang line of a script

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-11T18:48:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/11/llm-shebang/#atom-everything>

TIL: Using LLM in the shebang line of a script Kim_Bruning on Hacker News : But seriously, you can put a shebang on an english text file now (if you're sufficiently brave) [...] This inspired me to look at patterns for doing exactly that with LLM . Here's the simplest, which takes advantage of LLM fragments : `#!/usr/bin/env -S llm -f Generate an SVG of a pelican riding a bicycle` But you can also incorporate tool calls using the `-T name_of_tool` option: `#!/usr/bin/env -S llm -T llm_time -f Write a haiku that mentions the exact current time` Or even execute YAML templates directly that define extra tools as Python functions: `# !/usr/bin/env -S llm -t model : gpt-5.4-mini system : | Use tools to run calculations functions : | def add(a: int, b: int) -> int: return a + b def multiply(a: int, b: int) -> int: return a * b` Then: `./calc.sh 'what is 2344 * 5252 + 134' --td` Which outputs (thanks to that `--td` tools debug option): Tool call: `multiply({'a': 2344, 'b': 5252})` 12310688 Tool call: `add({'a': 12310688, 'b': 134})` 12310822 `2344 * 5252 + 134 = **12,310,822**` Read the full TIL for a more complex example that uses the Datasette SQL API to answer questions about content on my blog. Tags:...

4. Drata

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-17T17:59:15Z

Link: <https://drata.com/daring>

My thanks to Drata for sponsoring last week at DF. Their message is short and sweet: Leverage autonomous AI agents to automate compliance, manage internal and third-party risk, and continuously prove your security posture. ?

5. ArXiv to Ban Researchers for a Year if They Submit AI Slop

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-16T19:27:34Z

Link: <https://www.404media.co/new-arxiv-rules-ai-generated-papers-ban/>

Samantha Cole, writing for 404 Media: Late Thursday evening, Thomas Dietterich, chair of the computer science section of ArXiv, wrote on X : ?If generative AI tools generate inappropriate language, plagiarized content, biased content, errors, mistakes, incorrect references, or misleading content, and that output is included in scientific works, it is the responsibility of the author(s). We have recently clarified our penalties for this. If a submission contains incontrovertible evidence that the authors did not check the results of LLM generation, this means we can't trust anything in the paper.? [...] ?The penalty is a 1-year ban from arXiv followed by the requirement that subsequent arXiv submissions must first be accepted at a reputable peer-reviewed venue,? Dietterich wrote. Dietterich told me in an email on Friday morning that this is a one-strike rule ? meaning authors caught just once including AI slop in submissions will be banned ? but that decisions will be open to appeal. I see no cognitive dissonance in being pro-AI, in general, but vehemently anti-slop. ?

6. Dropover, a Mac Shelf Utility That Makes Clever Use of Mouse Shaking

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-15T19:24:10Z

Link: <https://dropoverapp.com/>

Yesterday, regarding the ?Magic Cursor? feature Google teased for its upcoming Googlebook/Aluminium OS platform, I wrote : Shaking your cursor over something is an interesting gesture. The only feature I'm aware of that uses that gesture is MacOS's feature that makes your cursor bigger when you shake it, to help spot it on the display. Then, last evening, I selected a few files on my desktop, started dragging them, and shook my mouse cursor to conjure a drop shelf from Dropover , a Mac utility by developer Damir Tursunovi? that I've been using for about two years. As soon I shook my mouse, I smiled and thought, ?Well, I should mention that.? So here I am, mentioning the gesture and Dropover. Years ago I recommended Yoink , which is very much a direct competitor to Dropover. The basic idea with both apps is that sometimes you want a temporary ?shelf? on which to drop items ? a way station between where you're dragging the items from and where you want to drop them. Yoink has options to appear only when you drag to the left edge of the screen, or to appear as soon as you start dragging anything. I have always used Yoink with it configured to show its shelf at the edge of the screen,...

7. In the Empire's Defense

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Sun, 17 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/the-empire-won?src=feed>

I didn't watch Star Wars when it was released. I wasn't even born. By the time we popped the cassette tape in the VCR, it was at least 15 years old. But I liked the movie all the same. It was not my favorite film by any means, but it was memorable. The first time you see Darth Vader appear on screen, you know this villain is not going to be easy to defeat. "Villain" because no one needs to tell you who the good guys and bad guys are in this movie. The visuals, the voices, the music, everything tells you that Darth Vader and the Empire are up to no good. Now I get to watch the movie with my kids. I quickly pointed out to my sons that this is the bad guy. Stating the obvious. One of them asked, "Why is he the bad guy?" I had to pause for a second to come up with an explanation. I didn't have an answer. Instead I said, "Because he is mean as hell!" They fell asleep before the movie ended. I think they enjoyed it. But I really couldn't tell you exactly why Darth Vader was the bad guy. This is just a thought experiment, don't go telling the world that I am pro-Galactic Empire, OK? I'm not digging into the lore of Star Wars. I did that already with the Galactic Timezones piece and it wa...

8. Our servers seem to have surprisingly low power consumption

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-17T03:04:44Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/tech/ServersLowPowerConsumption>

For reasons beyond the scope of this entry, today I was curious how much power our servers were using. If you have sufficiently fancy PDUs, I think you can get per-outlet measurements that are trustworthy, but we don't have such PDUs. Instead, the best I can do is look at the information that some of our servers report through IPMI. I'm not sure how accurate the IPMI information is, but at least some of the numbers seem plausible, so I'll assume that it's not massively off. The results surprise me with how low they were. Most of our servers are basic 1U servers with a pair of SATA SSDs. They're typically not very active, and the not particularly active servers that report IPMI power usage are reporting anything from 22 watts to 26 watts right now. A few servers also have a pair of HDDs, and one has four SSDs and is typically active; all of them report 44 watts right now. Our NFS file servers currently have 24 SSDs in each and are reporting a range of power usage from 47 watts to 62 watts. One interesting case is our perimeter firewall, where we have the active server and an identical running hot spare, both 1U servers. The active server is at 52 watts (and handling about 40 Mbyte...

9. GDS weighs in on the NHS's decision to retreat from Open Source

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 17 May 2020 11:34:30 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2020/05/gds-weighs-in-on-the-nhss-decision-to-retreat-from-open-source/>

Within the UK's Civil Service you occasionally hear the expression "being invited to a meeting without biscuits". It implies a rather frosty discussion without any of the polite niceties of a normal meeting. In general though, even when people have severe disagreements, it is rare for tempers to fray. It is even rarer for those internal disagreements to spill over into public. Which is what?

10. How to be inspired without copying

Source: Westenbergh. | Published: Sun, 17 May 2020 22:33:32 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenbergh.com/how-to-be-inspired-without-copying/>

In 1713, Johann Sebastian Bach sat down at his desk in Weimar and began copying out concertos by Antonio Vivaldi. He transcribed them note for note, in his own hand, working through at least nine of the L'estro armonico concertos like a medical student dissecting a cadaver. The

11. The new Galmon.eu Weekly Galileo Report

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2020 11:54:59 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/briefly-on-the-galmon-weekly-report/>

I have a longer story brewing, but in this post I want to briefly announce the "Galmon.eu unofficial Weekly Performance Report". This is a blog post version of an earlier Twitter thread. I'm very proud to present the first full Galmon.eu Weekly Galileo Report! And the good news is: it was a good week with very little to report. The email has just gone out, but you can also find it here.

12. Corona Update: Juli

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 01 Jul 2020 17:37:17 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-update-juli/>

Nu het RIVM gestopt is met dagelijkse updates vond ik dat het tijd was dat gat dan maar te vullen, al is het maar voor een dag. Een nieuwe Corona Update "hoe gaat het nu met?". De vorige was alweer van 21 april! De "Ik ben geen expert, maar toch"-factor Een boel dansleraren en opiniepeilers zijn inmiddels COVID-19 experts. In deze post heb ik erg mijn best gedaan alleen dingen te melden die we heel zeker weten.

13. COVID-19: The T Cell Story

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 05 Jun 2020 18:52:24 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/covid-19-t-cells/>

When COVID-19 burst on to the scene, tests quickly showed that the everyone was susceptible - no pre-existing antibodies were found that bound to the SARS-CoV-2 virus. This led to dire predictions that over 80% of the population might eventually fall ill. Now more than six months

in, this has not happened, and it does not appear to be close to happening. A few months ago, noted virologist Christian Drosten mused in his (German) podcast that some people might have a level of immunity after all, but he wasn't yet sure.